

Task 2: Cryptocurrency Portfolio Analysis

Performance and Risk Review: Bitcoin, Ethereum & Solana

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1. Introduction

This report looks at three major cryptocurrencies — Bitcoin (BTC), Ethereum (ETH), and Solana (SOL) — and reviews how each has performed over roughly the past 12 months, how risky each one currently appears compared to the others, and what this might mean for someone building a simple crypto portfolio. The figures used here are approximate, reflect prices around mid-June 2026, and are intended for learning purposes as part of an internship project rather than as financial advice.

2. Bitcoin (BTC)

Bitcoin is the original and largest cryptocurrency, often viewed as the 'benchmark' for the wider crypto market. As of mid-June 2026, BTC was trading at around \$64,000, giving it a market value of roughly \$1.27 trillion. Over the past 12 months, Bitcoin's price has fallen by approximately 19%, well below its all-time high of about \$126,200 reached in October 2025. Despite this pullback, Bitcoin remains by far the largest and most liquid cryptocurrency, and price movements in BTC tend to influence the rest of the crypto market.

3. Ethereum (ETH)

Ethereum is the second-largest cryptocurrency and is widely used as the foundation for smart contracts, decentralized finance (DeFi), and many other blockchain applications. As of mid-June 2026, ETH was trading at around \$1,674, with a market value of roughly \$202 billion. Unlike Bitcoin, Ethereum has actually gained ground over the past 12 months, rising by approximately 43.6% — making it the best performer of the three coins covered in this report, even though its price remains well below its previous highs.

4. Solana (SOL)

Solana is a newer blockchain network known for fast transaction speeds and low fees, and it has become popular for new token launches and applications. As of mid-June 2026, SOL was trading at around \$79, with a market value of roughly \$44.7 billion — the smallest of the three coins in this report. SOL has also been the weakest performer, down by an estimated 55% or more over the past 12 months, and it has experienced sharp short-term price swings, including a correction of over 45% in just the past month at one point. This makes it the most volatile of the three assets reviewed here.

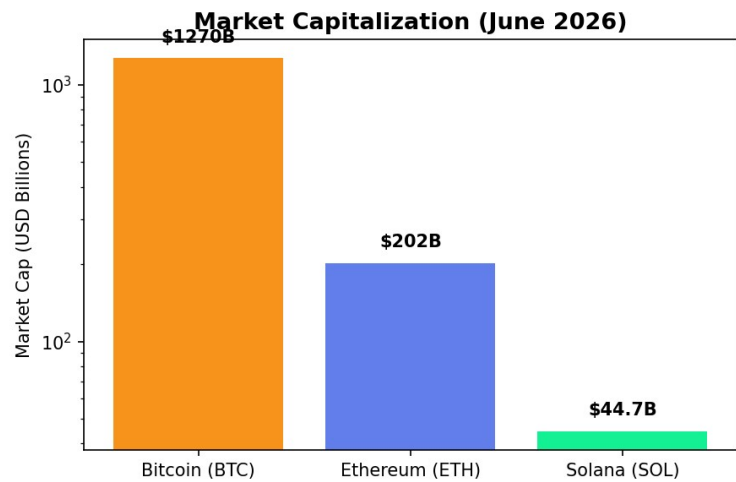
5. Side-by-Side Comparison

The table below summarises the approximate figures used in this report, all as of mid-June 2026.

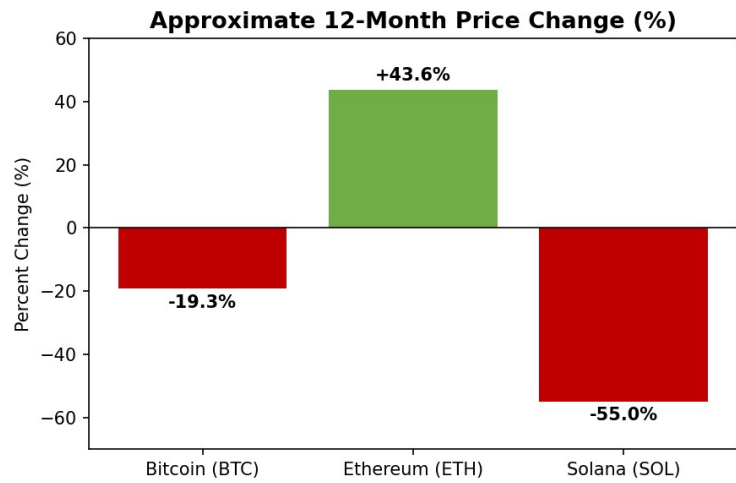
Cryptocurrency	Current Price	Approx. Market Cap	Approx. 12-Month Change
Bitcoin (BTC)	\$64,278	\$1.27 Trillion	-19.3%
Ethereum (ETH)	\$1,674	\$202 Billion	+43.6%
Solana (SOL)	\$78.88	\$44.7 Billion	-55.0% (approx.)

6. Charts

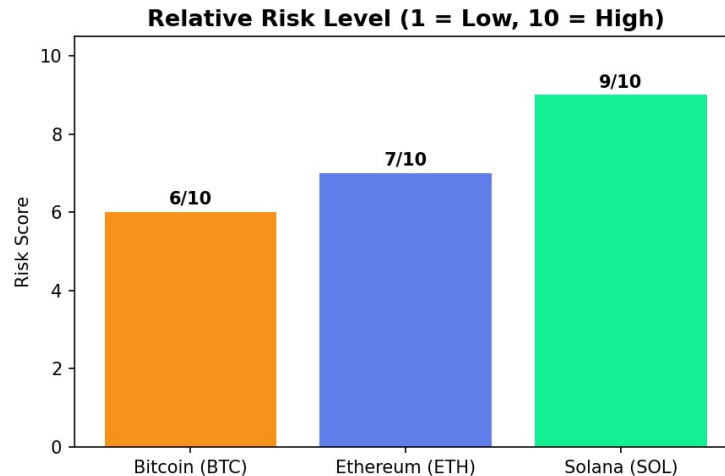
Market Capitalisation Comparison



Approximate 12-Month Performance



Relative Risk Level



7. Risk Analysis

Risk in cryptocurrency investing is closely linked to how much an asset's price tends to move up and down, and how established its network and user base are. Based on the figures above:

- Bitcoin (BTC) carries the lowest relative risk of the three. Its large market size, long track record, and wide adoption (including by institutional investors) make it the most stable option, even though it can still move significantly in price.
- Ethereum (ETH) sits in the middle. It is well established and widely used, but its price has historically been more volatile than Bitcoin's, and it remains sensitive to developments in the broader DeFi and smart contract space.
- Solana (SOL) carries the highest relative risk. Its smaller market size means prices can swing sharply on relatively small amounts of buying or selling, and its recent performance shows it can fall (or rise) much faster than the larger coins.

8. Insights and Recommendations

- Bitcoin (BTC) is best suited as the 'core' holding in a crypto portfolio, given its relative stability and market leadership position.
- Ethereum (ETH) has shown the strongest recent performance and offers a reasonable secondary holding, balancing growth potential with an established track record.
- Solana (SOL) should make up only a small portion of a portfolio, reflecting its higher risk and recent sharp price declines — suitable mainly for investors who are comfortable with significant ups and downs.

Overall, 2026 has been a difficult year for the broader crypto market, with most major coins trading well below their late-2025 highs. This kind of market-wide correction highlights the importance of diversification and a longer-term outlook rather than reacting to short-term price swings. This report is for educational purposes as part of an internship project and does not constitute financial advice.

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Crypto Data Table

Cryptocurrency	Current Price (USD)	Market Cap	12-Mo Change	Risk (1-10)	Notes
Bitcoin (BTC)	\$64,278	\$1.27 Trillion	-19.3%	6/10	Largest crypto; down from ATH ~\$126,200 (Oct 2025). Market benchmark.
Ethereum (ETH)	\$1,674	\$202 Billion	+43.6%	7/10	Best performer of the three YTD. Powers smart contracts & DeFi.
Solana (SOL)	\$78.88	\$44.7 Billion	-55.0% (approx.)	9/10	Fast & low-cost chain, but most volatile. Significant recent price swings.

Risk & Performance Summary

Best 12-month performer:	Ethereum (ETH), up approximately 43.6%
Weakest 12-month performer:	Solana (SOL), down approximately 55% (estimated)
Lowest relative risk:	Bitcoin (BTC) — largest market cap and most established
Highest relative risk:	Solana (SOL) — smallest market cap and most volatile
Overall market context:	Major cryptocurrencies have broadly traded below their late-2025 highs in 2026, reflecting a market-wide correction.

Recommendations

- Bitcoin (BTC)** is suitable as the 'core' or largest holding in a crypto allocation, given its relative stability and market leadership.
- Ethereum (ETH)** offers a balance of growth potential and established use cases, making it a reasonable secondary holding.
- Solana (SOL)** should be held in smaller amounts due to its high volatility — suitable only for investors comfortable with higher risk.
- Given the recent market-wide correction, a long-term, diversified approach is preferable to trying to time short-term price swings.